

# Seth Walker

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## Contact Information

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## Education

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|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Ph.D.</b> | Economics, Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI                                              | Expected May 2026 |
| <b>M.A.</b>  | Economics, Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI                                              | 2022              |
| <b>B.S.</b>  | Economics, James Madison University, Harrisonburg, VA, <i>summa cum laude</i><br>MINOR: MATHEMATICS | 2020              |
| <b>B.M.</b>  | Music Performance, James Madison University, Harrisonburg, VA, <i>summa cum laude</i>               | 2020              |

## Research Interests

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Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Public Economics, and Economics of Education

## Job Market Paper

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- *Losing Aid, Losing Ground? The Academic and Career Consequences of Financial Aid Loss: Evidence from the TEXAS Grant.* Under Review. [\[PDF\]](#)

## Publications

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- *Measuring Teacher Effectiveness for Gifted and Talented Students* - with Scott Imberman and Katharine Strunk. *Economics of Education Review*, 2025. [\[DOI\]](#) | [\[PDF\]](#)
- *Financial Aid Package Composition and Postsecondary Outcomes for Low-income Students: Evidence from the Spartan Advantage Program.* Forthcoming in *Education Finance and Policy*. [\[DOI\]](#) | [\[PDF\]](#)
- *The Path of Student Learning Delay During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Evidence from Michigan* - with Katharine Strunk, Tara Kilbride, Scott Imberman, Dongming Yu, Bryant Hopkins. Forthcoming in *Education Finance and Policy*. [\[DOI\]](#) | [\[PDF\]](#)

## Working Papers

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- *Teaching on Borrowed Time: How the Teacher Loan Forgiveness Program Delays, But Does Not Prevent, Teacher Attrition.* [\[PDF\]](#)

## Work in Progress

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- *Estimating the Overall Effects of Statewide Early Literacy Policies: Evidence from Michigan* - with Josep Nadal-Fernandez and Tara Kilbride.

## Technical Reports

- *Retention and Exemption Decisions Under the Read by Grade Three Law* - with Tara Kilbride and Josep Nadal-Fernandez - EPIC Research Report, 2024. [\[Report\]](#)
- *Insight to MSU's Applicant Funnel: An Introduction & Foundation* - with Emilio Esposito and Steven Miller, Office for Enrollment & Strategic Planning Report, 2024. [\[Report\]](#)
- *Read by Grade Three Retention Eligibility: 2023 Update* - with Tara Kilbride, EPIC Research Report, 2023. [\[Report\]](#)

## Conference and Seminar Presentations

2025: Association for Public Policy and Management (Upcoming); Midwest Economics of Education (Flash Talk, Upcoming); MSU Empirical Micro Seminar; MSU Grand River Conference; UM-MSU-UWO Labor Day; Midwest Economics Association; Association for Education and Finance Policy  
2024: Southern Economics Association; MSU Empirical Micro Seminar  
2023: MSU Red Cedar Conference

## Research Experience

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Research Assistant, Education Policy Innovation Collaborative (MSU)                             | Spring 2023-            |
| Research Assistant, Professor Scott Imberman (MSU)                                              | Spring 2023-Summer 2025 |
| Research Assistant, Professor Steven Miller and Dr. Emilio Esposito (MSU Office of the Provost) | Spring 2022-Summer 2025 |
| Research Assistant, Professor Vipul Bhatt (JMU)                                                 | Spring 2018-Spring 2020 |

## Teaching Experience

|                                              |             |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Instructor</b>                            |             |
| EC 370 - Economics of Sports                 | Summer 2022 |
| <b>Teaching Assistant</b>                    |             |
| ISS 328 - The Social Science of Sports       | Fall 2022   |
| EC 425 - Law and Economics                   | Spring 2022 |
| EC 420 - Introduction to Econometric Methods | Fall 2021   |
| EC 301 - Intermediate Microeconomics         | Spring 2021 |
| EC 302 - Intermediate Macroeconomics         | Fall 2020   |

## Grants & Awards

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Travel Fellowship (MSU)                                                 | 2025 |
| Research Enhancement Award (MSU)                                        | 2024 |
| Red Cedar Award (MSU)                                                   | 2023 |
| <i>Awarded for best third-year paper among Economics Ph.D. students</i> |      |
| Faculty Award for Academic Excellence in Economics (JMU)                | 2020 |
| The Phi Beta Kappa Society (JMU)                                        | 2019 |

## Service

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### Referee Service

Education Finance and Policy, Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis

### University Service

Enrollment and Academic Strategic Planning Think Tank

2022-2023

Department of Economics First-Year Mentor

2021-2022

## Software

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R, Stata, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

## References

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### Scott Imberman (Chair)

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### Todd Elder

*Professor*

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### Steven Miller

*Professor*

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and Resource Economics

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### Tara Kilbride

*Associate Director*

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